Katrina Ridout
NUTRITION

A FREE GUIDE FROM AN ACCREDITED PRACTISING DIETITIAN

Nourished

7 evidence-based nutrition foundations for fertility, pregnancy & beyond

The small number of things that actually have good evidence behind them, explained without judgement or fear.

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BEFORE WE START

Less noise. More of what matters.

Whether you're trying to conceive, in the thick of pregnancy, or finding your feet as a new mum, the internet has probably handed you a hundred contradictory food rules and a fair amount of fear.

This guide is the opposite of that. I'm Katrina, an Accredited Practising Dietitian, and I work with women through fertility, pregnancy and the first couple of years of motherhood. What follows is not another list of forbidden foods. It's the handful of foundations that genuinely have evidence behind them, written the way I'd explain them to you in a consult.

Take what's useful. Leave what isn't. And please be kind to yourself as you go.

> This is general information to help you feel clearer and calmer. It isn't a substitute for advice tailored to you, your body and your stage. For that, your own dietitian, GP or specialist is the right person.

THE FOUNDATIONS

Start here

1 A broadly Mediterranean-style pattern is the strongest base

Vegetables, legumes, whole grains, fish, olive oil, and not much ultra-processed food. It's the eating pattern most consistently linked with better outcomes across fertility and pregnancy. Think of it as a flexible shape, not a rulebook.

2 Protein at each meal does more than any single "superfood"

It steadies your energy and appetite through nausea, through treatment, and through the bone-deep tiredness of early motherhood. A palm-sized serve at each meal is a simple place to aim.

3 Folate and iodine are the two to get right early

From food and an appropriate supplement. These matter most in the early weeks, often before many women even know the exact numbers to aim for. Your GP or dietitian will confirm what's right for you.

4 Iron is the quiet one that flattens so many women

Through trying to conceive, pregnancy, and especially the postpartum months. Pairing iron-rich foods with a little vitamin C helps your body absorb more of it.

THE FOUNDATIONS

And the ones nobody tells you

5

You don't need to "eat for two"

Energy needs rise modestly, and mostly later in pregnancy. The quality of what you eat matters far more than the quantity. This one quietly takes a lot of pressure off.

6

Nausea nutrition is damage control, not perfection

Cold foods, small and frequent, and the carbs you can actually keep down. When you're feeling awful, getting *something* in beats getting it "right". Perfect is not the goal here.

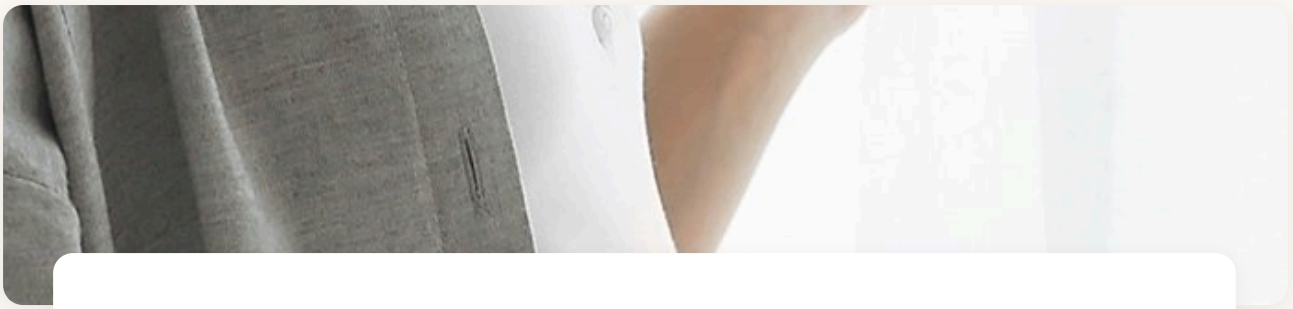
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Postpartum, you are still recovering — and often feeding someone

Under-eating is incredibly common in these months, and it works against you. Simple, prepared-ahead, nutrient-dense food is self-care, not indulgence. You matter in this equation too.

> Notice what's missing from this list: fear, guilt, and forbidden-food lists. None of those help you, and most of them aren't backed by good evidence anyway.

IF YOU'D LIKE A HAND



Support that's actually tailored to you

None of this needs to be perfect. But if you'd like guidance built around your body, your stage and your real life, that's exactly what I do, over telehealth right across Australia.

You can book a free 15-minute callback. No pitch, just a chat to see if I can help.

Book a free 15-minute chat

Kat xx

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This guide provides general information only and is not personal medical or nutrition advice. It does not diagnose, treat or replace individual care. Please consult your own dietitian, GP or specialist for guidance specific to your circumstances.